

Tirzepatide

Tirzepatide (Mounjaro / Zepbound)

FAT LOSS

INSULIN
SENSITIVITY

GIP

CARDIOVASCULAR

FDA APPROVED

WHAT IS IT?

Tirzepatide is a once-weekly dual GIP/GLP-1 receptor agonist approved by the FDA for type 2 diabetes (Mounjaro) and obesity (Zepbound). SURMOUNT-1 trials demonstrated 22.5% body weight reduction at the highest dose — currently the most effective approved weight loss medication. Adding GIP agonism to GLP-1 produces synergistic metabolic effects.

DOSING AT A GLANCE

Starting Dose	Max Dose	Frequency	Titration
2.5 mg/wk	15 mg/wk	Once weekly	4-week steps

KEY BENEFITS

- 22.5% body weight reduction at 15 mg/week (SURMOUNT-1) — best of any approved drug
- Superior HbA1c reduction vs. semaglutide (SURPASS trials)
- Significant visceral fat reduction
- Improved insulin sensitivity and beta-cell function
- Liver fat reduction (MAFLD/NASH improvement)
- Cardiovascular risk reduction (SURPASS-CVOT underway)
- Reduced hypertension and improved lipid profiles
- Better GI tolerability than semaglutide at equivalent doses

HOW IT WORKS

Tirzepatide is a 'twincretin' — a single molecule that acts on both GLP-1R and GIPR with balanced potency. GIP agonism synergizes with GLP-1 to enhance insulin secretion, improve adipose tissue metabolism, and reduce glucagon. The combined receptor activation produces greater weight loss than GLP-1 alone.

PROTOCOLS

- **Standard:** 2.5 mg x4 weeks → 5 mg x4 → 7.5 → 10 → 12.5 → 15 mg/week.

- **Aggressive recomp:** Pair with calorie deficit, 1g/lb protein, 3–4x resistance training.
- **Maintenance:** Lowest dose maintaining body composition goals.
- **Semaglutide switch:** No washout needed — titrate up from starting Tirzepatide dose.

SIDE EFFECTS

- Nausea, vomiting (less than semaglutide at comparable doses)
- Diarrhea, constipation
- Muscle mass loss (critical to offset with training + protein)
- Injection site erythema, bruising
- Hypoglycemia when combined with sulfonylureas or insulin

STORAGE

Refrigerate 2–8°C. After first use: 2–8°C or room temp up to 21 days (pen).

■ **Same thyroid tumor warnings as GLP-1 class. Not for personal/family history of MTC or MEN2.**

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